# How I Built the Audits: Method and Tools

Vuori and GlassesUSA Agentic Readiness Audits · Oct 17, 2026 · @or

## Summary

Both audits followed the same method: AI tools collected data and wrote drafts, and I checked every claim and made the calls. The result is two 8-slide decks and two client emails. Every number in them traces back to a saved file: a screenshot, a raw server response, or a row in a run log.

The work ran in six steps for each brand: framing, product selection, technical inspection (Step A), AI visibility testing (Phase C, 30 runs per brand), scoring and prioritisation (Step F), and the deck and email. Vuori came first, with the method built along the way. GlassesUSA reused that method and was mostly automated.

One rule held throughout: AI output is checked before it is used. Each engine claim that appears in a deck was checked against the brand's own pages and marked in a `verification` column. Twice the check reversed a conclusion the AI had drawn (section 4).

## Tools used

The tools fall into two groups. The first is the AI I worked with. The second is the AI agents the brands want to sell through, which I tested only as a shopper would see them.

| Tool | Group | How I used it |
|---|---|---|
| Claude (Opus and Fable models), in a cloud workspace linked to my PC | Working AI | Main analyst and engineer. Read the brief, wrote the methodology, fetched pages and parsed raw HTML and JSON-LD, wrote the scripts, filled the run logs, drafted findings, built the decks and emails. |
| Claude in Chrome (browser agent) | Working AI | Ran the AI visibility prompts in ChatGPT, Perplexity and Gemini: new chat, pasted prompt, screenshots, copied the full answer, wrote a log row. Also walked guest checkout and the lens configurator without buying. |

| Tool | Group | How I used it |
|---|---|---|
| ARGON | Working AI | Strategy and red-team role: shaped the scoring rubric, the commercial framing and the slide structure, and challenged findings as a sceptical ecommerce lead. |
| Grok | Working AI | Independent second auditor on GlassesUSA. It ran Step A through its own orchestrator and set of sub-agents, and I compared its report with ours line by line. |
| Python and shell scripts | Working tools | `phase_c_metrics.py` computes every Phase C number from the CSV, so no number is typed by hand. `score.py` computes the weighted score. Crawler tests check HTTP status per user agent. |
| PowerShell crawler test, run on my own PC | Working tools | Sent 13 user agents (GPTBot, PerplexityBot, Googlebot, Bingbot and others) to 7 GlassesUSA pages, twice, and saved every blocked response. |
| US VPN (Windscribe, Dallas) and a dedicated Chrome profile | Test setup | Every engine saw a US shopper with a new account, an English UI and no history. Location was checked with ipinfo.io before each batch. |
| ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini (consumer apps, default free models, web search on) | Tested agents | The subject of the audit. Temporary or incognito chats, one chat per run, identical prompt text. |
| `agentic-audit-deck` skill | Working tools | A saved instruction set, written after Vuori, that turns an evidence folder into the 8-slide deck and email using the same rules each time. |

## Workflow

In every step the AI did the repetitive work and I made the decision at the end of it. The table shows each step, who did what, and the file it left behind.

| Step | What happened | Done by AI | Decided or checked by me | Output |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0. Framing | Read the brief, settled scope, studied 40rty.ai | Read the brief and flagged the Vuori/GlassesUSA wording conflict; summarised 40rty's product and its 4 KPIs | Asked 40rty and got the answer: two separate audits. Required every finding to name a 40rty KPI (Agent Sessions, Conversion, Attributed Revenue, AOV) | Methodology PDF v1.1 |
| 1. Products | Picked 4 hero products per brand | Proposed candidates from the sitemap, best-sellers and review counts | Chose the final 4 per brand, each tied to one shopper prompt | `PRODUCT_SELECTION` notes |
| 2. Step A: technical | Platform, crawler access, raw vs rendered HTML, schema, catalog, policies, checkout | Fetched and parsed pages, dumped JSON-LD, compared prices across page, schema and data layer | Ran the crawler test from my PC; walked guest checkout to the payment step; re-checked each finding as a guest | `STEP_A_findings_<brand>.md`, raw files, screenshots |
| 3. Phase C: AI visibility | 5 shopper prompts × 3 engines, the 2 main prompts 3 times each (27 runs), plus 3 purchase-task runs | The browser agent ran the prompts and saved screenshots, full text and a CSV row per run | Wrote the prompts; ran Vuori's first prompt by hand; reviewed screenshots; captured the brand's own page right after the purchase task as ground truth | `ai_runs/`, `ai_visibility_log_<brand>.csv`, `PHASE_C_summary_<brand>.md` |
| 4. Verification | Checked every engine claim used in a deck | Looked up each claim on the brand's site and proposed a status | Accepted, reversed or left open each one in the `verification` column | `verification` column |

| Step | What happened | Done by AI | Decided or checked by me | Output |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5. Step F: scoring and plan | 6 aspects scored 0–4, weighted to 0–100; 6 ranked actions | Script computed metrics and the score; drafted the action plan and red-team questions | Set the final scores and weights; ranked the fixes; prepared answers to pushback | `STEP_F_scoring_and_plan` (GlassesUSA), `score.py` |
| 6. Deck and email | 8 slides and an email under 200 words per brand | Built slides from verified files only; counted the email's words | Approved the storyline and every slide title; replaced blurry screenshots with exact quotes | `deck/` folder: PDF, email, source |

Final scores: Vuori 58/100, GlassesUSA 53/100, both "Partially ready".

## How AI output was checked

Nothing went into a deck straight from an AI tool. Four checks made sure of that:

1. **Primary source for every claim.** Each engine claim on a slide (price, fabric, inseam, rating, return window, whether a product exists) was checked against the brand's own page or schema and marked CONFIRMED, ENGINE ERROR or OPEN.
2. **Ground truth for the purchase task.** Straight after the agents tried to buy one exact variant, I recorded the brand's own page: stock, price and URL format. For GlassesUSA that was the Ray-Ban RB2140 at $215.50 with single-vision Rx sun lenses, which no agent stated correctly (0 of 6 answers).
3. **Numbers from scripts.** Mention rates, share of voice and the final score are computed from the CSV, so re-running the script reproduces every figure.
4. **A second, independent AI.** On GlassesUSA, Grok ran its own Step A. I re-checked every claim that only Grok made on the live site before accepting it.

Errors caught this way:

| Where | What the AI said | What was true | Effect |
|---|---|---|---|
| Vuori, Phase C | Our automation marked Gemini's "Vuori Cascade Tech Chino" as a hallucination | The product is real (vuoriclothing.com/collections/cascade-collection) | Gemini was right; the label was removed. Calling something a hallucination now requires checking the brand's sitemap first |
| Vuori, Phase C | Automation logged a feed rating of 2,254 reviews as the product-page rating | The product page shows 26,547 reviews | Became a finding in its own right: the feed under-reports reviews |
| GlassesUSA, product selection | Sutro shown at $203 and also at $152.25, read as a schema price mismatch | $152.25 was a coupon applied only when logged in; a guest sees $203 | Not reported as a finding |
| GlassesUSA, Grok cross-check | Grok repeated the same Sutro price split and reported the help centre as blocked (HTTP 403) | Same coupon effect; our browser read the help centre normally | Corrected. Four other Grok-only claims were confirmed and added, e.g. `/sitemap.xml` returns HTTP 500 and an existing Rx-eligibility flag sits in the page data but not the schema |

## From Vuori to GlassesUSA: what got faster

Vuori built the method, and GlassesUSA reused it with most of the data collection automated. After Vuori I wrote down the lessons in two reusable files: an automation playbook and the `agentic-audit-deck` skill.

| | Vuori (first) | GlassesUSA (second) |
|---|---|---|
| Visibility runs | First prompt by hand (about 4 hours), the rest by the browser agent (about 40 minutes) | All 30 runs by the browser agent, one setup for every run |
| Discarded runs | 2 (a Gemini account with a Hebrew UI; a prompt with a dropped letter) | 0 |
| Crawler test | Script written, not run | Run twice from my PC: 13 user agents × 7 pages |
| Second opinion | None | Independent Step A by Grok, cross-checked |
| Deck | Built and designed slide by slide | Built from the saved skill, with the same structure and rules |

Lessons turned into run rules for the second audit:

- **VPN for the whole PC, not one browser**, checked on ipinfo.io before each batch. A browser-only VPN missed other browsers, and Google blocked one Atlanta exit IP (HTTP 403).
- **English accounts, temporary chats, default models.** The Hebrew Gemini UI forced a re-run.
- **Prompts pasted from a file, never typed.** One dropped letter ("hat are…") voided a run.
- **A fixed capture order:** screenshots, then the sources panel, then the copied text. Gemini's copy drops links, so its sources come from screenshots.
- **Ground truth captured right after the purchase task**, because stock and prices change.
- **One writer at a time on the run log**, so no rows are lost.

## Limitations and assumptions

The audits are a snapshot of what a US shopper saw on 14–17 Oct 2026, and the decks say so.

- **AI answers change from run to run.** Results are reported as "X of N runs", the two main prompts were repeated 3 times each, and no claim rests on a single run.
- **Free consumer tiers only.** Paid tiers may answer differently. The test is what a typical shopper gets, not an API.
- **Public data only.** No contact with either brand, no accounts in their name, no purchases. Checkout was walked to the shipping step and stopped there.
- **Some things can't be seen from outside:** feed status in Merchant Center or OpenAI, bot rules by IP, conversion by agent. Each is listed as an open question for the client, not guessed.
- **The bot challenges may partly reflect VPN IPs.** The GlassesUSA slide says so, and the client's server logs can settle it in an hour.
- **Vuori mixed manual and automated runs** (first prompt by hand, the rest by agent). This is noted in the log; GlassesUSA used one setup for every run.
- **Engine screenshots that weren't readable** were replaced with exact quotes from the saved answer text, so evidence stays checkable.

## Where to find the evidence

Each brand has the same folder layout, so any number in a deck can be traced back to its source.

| Folder or file | What it holds |
|---|---|
| `Method/` | Methodology and workflow (v1.1) and the automation playbook, shared by both brands |
| `Skills/agentic-audit-deck/` | The skill that builds the deck and email from an evidence folder |
| `<brand>/evidence/STEP_A_findings_<brand>.md` | Technical inspection: platform, crawlers, schema, catalog, policies, checkout |
| `<brand>/evidence/ai_visibility_log_<brand>.csv` | One row per AI run, with the `verification` column |
| `<brand>/evidence/ai_runs/` | Screenshots per prompt, full answer text in `_text/`, prompts and ground truth in `README.txt` |
| `<brand>/evidence/PHASE_C_summary_<brand>.md` | Visibility metrics, findings, open items, setup notes |

| Folder or file | What it holds |
|---|---|
| `Glassesusa/evidence/STEP_A_cross_check_vs_Grok.md` | Line-by-line comparison with Grok's independent audit |
| `Glassesusa/evidence/STEP_F_scoring_and_plan_glassesusa.md` | Scores, action plan, red-team answers |
| `Glassesusa/scripts/` | `phase_c_metrics.py` and `score.py`; re-run to reproduce every number |
| `<brand>/deck/` | The deck (PDF), the client email and the slide source |
| `GROK_TEST_glassesusa/` | Grok's orchestrator, agent instructions and raw output |